The Book of Abraham

The Belief Files

Case File 003

Historical investigation and biblical assessment

Beyond the Message | Religion Comparison | November 8, 2026

Investigation summary

In 1835, Joseph Smith and other Latter-day Saints acquired Egyptian mummies and papyri in Kirtland, Ohio. Smith connected the collection with the biblical patriarch Abraham. An English work appeared in the *Times and Seasons* in 1842, accompanied by three Egyptian illustrations and explanations. The Book of Abraham later became part of the Pearl of Great Price, accepted as LDS scripture in 1880. [2–3, 11]

Unlike the Book of Mormon plates, some of the Egyptian material remains available for examination. The surviving fragments contain Egyptian funerary writings. Their recoverable language does not translate into the English Book of Abraham. The illustrations and the nineteenth-century working papers supply further evidence, although they do not preserve every step of production. [4–8, 14–15]

This creates the central question: **What connects the English Book of Abraham to ancient Abraham, and how well does that connection survive the evidence we can test?** A second question follows: if the work came through revelation rather than a conventional translation, what evidence establishes that revelation as authoritative?

The strongest historical difficulty is the mismatch between recoverable Egyptian material and the meanings assigned to it. The strongest limitation is the incomplete collection: some papyri are missing, and the production process is not fully documented. A responsible investigation must retain both facts.

Finding in brief: The record establishes an Egyptian acquisition, nineteenth-century manuscripts, and publication under Smith's authority. It does not establish a verified translation of an Abrahamic text. Missing-papyrus and revelatory explanations deserve examination, but neither has independently demonstrated the claimed ancient source. These findings do not, by themselves, establish that Smith knowingly committed fraud.

The claim under investigation

The 1842 heading presented the work as a translation of ancient records associated with Abraham in Egypt. Its description included the phrase **"Written by his own hand, upon Papyrus."** The published illustrations also assigned names, identities, and meanings to specific figures. These are more particular claims than the general statement that a book inspires its readers. [11, 17–19]

Three claims need separate tests:

- **Ancient authorship:** The work conveys a genuine record associated with Abraham. A later copy could, in principle, preserve an older composition; the surviving papyrus need not be Abraham's physical autograph for that narrower claim to be true.
- **Translation or revelation:** Smith produced the English work through divine assistance. This could mean rendering an Egyptian text, recovering a lost text by revelation, or receiving revelation prompted by the artifacts. Those models make different predictions.
- **Scriptural authority:** The resulting teachings should be received as God's word. Neither the existence of papyri nor the fact of publication settles this theological claim.

The Church's current essay defends the book as scripture while allowing uncertainty about its relationship to the surviving fragments and about the meaning of translation in this setting. That is a substantive religious defense, not an admission that the book is false. It also means a reader should identify which model is being defended before weighing evidence. [2]

How this investigation weighs evidence

This case develops the supplied research packet's Book of Abraham study and checks its central historical claims against published documents and specialist analyses. The packet is a working synthesis, not an additional independent witness. Where an argument remains disputed, the disagreement is identified. [1]

An artifact answers a narrower question than a testimony. A papyrus can establish what Egyptian writing survives. A journal can establish that a scribe recorded translation activity. A participant can report what Smith said or did. None of those observations automatically establishes that Abraham authored the English work.

Agreement must be independent and relevant. Several people repeating Smith's identification of a scroll demonstrate the circulation of that identification. Their agreement becomes stronger evidence for ancient authorship only if they could independently identify the text, its language, or its provenance.

A testable failure and an untestable possibility have different weight. A surviving caption can be compared with a specialist reading. A lost document might have contained additional material, but its possible contents cannot be treated as recovered evidence. The absence of the missing portion also prevents pretending that every original claim has been completely tested.

Historical and theological judgments remain distinct. Historical evidence can weigh a claimed translation without settling every question about God. Christian comparison can evaluate doctrine without pretending that a biblical cross-reference deciphers Egyptian. The same standards should apply to sources used in defense of Christianity.

The historical timeline

Date	What the record shows	Investigative significance
July 1835	Chandler's Egyptian collection was acquired in Kirtland. Early reports connected the papyri with Abraham and Joseph. [3, 12]	The Abraham identification began near the acquisition, rather than first appearing in 1842.
1835	English Abraham manuscripts, alphabet documents, and a grammar project were produced. A journal entry on October 1 records work on an Egyptian alphabet. [5–9]	Material evidence survives from the early production period. Its exact sequence and purpose require interpretation.
March-May 1842	The book and three facsimiles appeared in the *Times and Seasons*. March journal entries record translation and revision activity. [10–11]	Publication and continuing work are documented; a modern reconstruction should not reduce everything to one observed session.
1844	Joseph Coe wrote about the acquisition, financial contributions, and an expectation of recovering costs through publication. [13]	Financial investment and anticipated benefit both belong in the motive analysis.
1856 and afterward	The collection was sold and dispersed. Some original material is no longer extant. [3]	Today's collection is incomplete. Claims about what missing rolls contained require evidence beyond their absence.
1880	The Pearl of Great Price, including Abraham, was accepted as LDS scripture. [2]	The authority claim became part of the Church's recognized canon.

Date	What the record shows	Investigative significance
1967	A group of surviving papyrus fragments was returned to the Church from the Metropolitan Museum of Art. [2–4]	Direct specialist examination became possible; the original papyri behind all three facsimiles were not recovered.

The chronology is secure at this broad level. It does not supply a continuous account of the translation process. An event dated to 1835 in a later compiled history must also be distinguished from an entry actually written in an 1835 journal. [3, 9]

Exhibit one The surviving papyri

The fragments are genuine ancient Egyptian artifacts. Calling their content funerary does not mean they are modern forgeries. The fragment associated with Facsimile 1 belongs to the Book of Breathing for Horos, an Egyptian priest. The Joseph Smith Papers dates that artifact to between 238 and approximately 153 BC. This is much later than Abraham's traditional setting. [4]

Age alone is not the decisive objection. The physical manuscripts of many ancient works are later than their authors. A copy from a later period could transmit an earlier story. To establish that possibility here, however, one would need evidence that the later Egyptian text actually preserves Abrahamic material. A late date does not demonstrate such transmission, and it does not disprove it by itself.

Klaus Baer's examination and translation identify a funerary document concerned with the deceased Hor. Robert Ritner's later philological analysis likewise reads the material within Egyptian mortuary religion. Their readings supply a positive identification, rather than merely an inability to find the English book. [14–15]

The relevant comparison is therefore between **what the surviving Egyptian says** and **what the proposed English translation says**. An Egyptian prayer or provision for the deceased does not become Abraham's first-person

narrative simply because both discuss religion. Shared religious vocabulary is not a linguistic correspondence.

Some of Smith's papyri are missing. That matters: we cannot translate a lost portion or rule out every conceivable text it might have contained. It also sets a limit on the defense. A missing Abraham manuscript has not been recovered, dated, or read. Its existence remains a proposed explanation, not an established discovery. [3, 16]

Exhibit finding: The surviving material supplies evidence against a conventional translation of that material into the English Book of Abraham. It cannot, on its own, settle the contents of every lost piece.

Exhibit two The Egyptian working papers

The surviving English manuscripts contain Egyptian or Egyptian-like characters beside passages of English Abraham text. Manuscript C begins with an explicit translation heading. Alphabet documents and the *Grammar and Alphabet of the Egyptian Language* place characters alongside proposed English meanings. These objects connect the Egyptian project with the emerging English work. [5–8]

That relationship is difficult to dismiss as wholly unrelated to translation. It does not, however, reveal a complete mechanical procedure. Did a character generate an English passage? Was an already received passage later attached to a character? Were the papers used to systematize revelatory knowledge? Different sequences imply different accounts of production.

The documents should not all be called Smith's handwritten grammar. Multiple scribes participated. Smith's handwriting appears in Egyptian Alphabet A, while the grammar was principally inscribed by associates. Distinguishing handwriting establishes participation more carefully than attributing every line to one man. [7–8]

If the English had already been received and the characters were attached afterward, the claim that these pages show character-by-character dictation would weaken. It would not turn the proposed Egyptian meanings into accurate readings. If the characters prompted the English, the mismatch

would bear more directly on the translation procedure. Either way, the documents need explanation.

Exhibit finding: The papers show an active attempt to associate Egyptian signs and English religious meanings. They preserve evidence of production and interpretation, not a demonstrated decipherment yielding Abraham's narrative. Their precise order and role remain contested. [5–8]

Exhibit three The facsimiles

The facsimiles are especially useful because the published explanations make specific assertions. They should be examined separately: their originals have different survival histories, and the available images do not all preserve equally clear details. [4, 17–19]

Facsimile	Available evidence	Question to test
1: the lion-couch scene	A damaged ancient vignette survives, together with the 1842 engraved version and its explanations. [4, 11, 17]	Does the funerary scene independently identify Abraham, an attempted sacrifice, and the named participants?
2: the circular image	The published hypocephalus and explanations survive; its original papyrus is not extant. [16, 18]	Do the Egyptian image and text establish the astronomical and theological meanings assigned to them?
3: the enthroned scene	The 1842 engraving and explanations survive; the original papyrus is not extant. [16, 19]	Do the figures and captions support the stated people, roles, and names?

Facsimile 1 The scene and the missing details

The LDS explanation identifies Abraham on an altar and a priest attempting to sacrifice him. The archival introduction instead records the common Egyptological understanding of a corpse being reanimated by Anubis. The question concerns the scene's Egyptian context and details, not whether Egyptians ever depicted danger or ritual action. [4, 17]

The original is damaged. Missing parts, nineteenth-century restoration, and the engraving must be distinguished. An argument that depends entirely on a reconstructed hand, knife, or head needs to show what actually survives. Neither an LDS reconstruction nor a critical reconstruction should be mistaken for an intact photograph of the ancient image.

Facsimile 2 Astronomical explanation and Egyptian context

The LDS explanations assign meanings including Kolob and governing celestial relationships. Egyptological analysis treats the object as a hypocephalus: a funerary image placed in relation to the deceased. Establishing the Egyptian type is one question; establishing that it communicates the published Abrahamic cosmology is another. [15, 18]

A revelatory reading might claim a second meaning beyond the image's ordinary Egyptian use. That is a theological proposal requiring its own warrant. A symbolic association can be meaningful to a believer without demonstrating a translation of the inscriptions. Because the original is missing, conclusions about damaged signs and copied details must acknowledge the limits of the engraving.

Facsimile 3 Specific identifications

This explanation identifies the enthroned figure as Abraham, another figure as Pharaoh, and another as a prince. Ritner's reading identifies an Osirian funerary scene, including Osiris, Isis, Maat, and the deceased Hor. Those differences concern central identities, rather than small variations in spelling. [15, 19]

There is a serious LDS response to consider. Smoot, Gee, Muhlestein, and Thompson argue that some engraved glyphs are poorly preserved and that

Isis has Egyptian royal associations. Their discussion also reports that both Ritner and LDS Egyptologist Michael Rhodes read the figure in question as Isis. The response deserves attention because it addresses the image's ancient symbolic setting. [20]

The remaining distinction is between **royal associations** and **a caption actually naming Pharaoh**. Showing that Isis relates to kingship does not by itself establish the particular name claim in the published explanation. Conversely, uncertainty about copied glyphs should prevent overstating how directly every damaged sign can be read.

Exhibit finding: The available facsimiles present substantial problems for the published identifications as ordinary Egyptian readings. A symbolic or revelatory reinterpretation is a different defense. It should be assessed explicitly rather than allowed to change the claim without notice.

Assessing the principal accounts

Witnesses can establish acquisition, handling, work sessions, publication, and early belief. Their testimony becomes evidence for an accurate ancient translation only when their competence and access extend to that question.

Witness or record	What it can support	What it cannot establish alone
Michael Chandler's certificate, July 6, 1835	A dealer endorsed Smith's interpretation. The surviving record is a later 1835 copy and a contemporary published version. [12]	An independent, controlled translation audit by a qualified Egyptologist.
Smith's journals, kept by scribes	Egyptian study and later translation or revision were recorded as activities. [9–10]	A complete description of how the English words were obtained.

Witness or record	What it can support	What it cannot establish alone
English and Egyptian manuscripts	Several participants worked on texts connecting characters and English explanations. [5–8]	The truth of the ancient authorship assigned to the resulting English.
Joseph Coe's 1844 letter	A participant described financial commitments and publication expectations about nine years after acquisition. [13]	Smith's private motives or a complete accounting of the project.
Modern Egyptologists	Egyptian language, funerary parallels, names, and image types can be examined using comparative evidence. [14–15, 20]	Whether God could reveal a separate text through an artifact.

Chandler's certificate matters historically, but the credential must not grow beyond its evidence. A seller's report that Smith's explanation corresponded with information received from learned people is not the same as preserving those people's independent translations for comparison. It also came from a transaction in which Chandler had a financial interest. Neither point proves that he lied. [12]

The journal entries are stronger evidence for recorded activity than later reminiscence would be. Yet “translating” in a journal identifies the activity as participants understood it; it does not give an observer independent knowledge of the ancient text. The 1842 entries also mention revision, which cautions against imagining a process with no editorial work. [9–10]

Expertise should also be kept within its field. A critic's religious hostility does not invalidate an Egyptian reading; an LDS scholar's faith does not invalidate one either. The relevant questions are whether the reading fits the signs, grammar, and comparable texts, and whether other qualified readers can check it.

The strongest LDS argument

The strongest defense begins with an incomplete collection. John Gee argues that descriptions of a long roll favor a source now lost, rather than the mounted fragments available today. His position explains why a translation of surviving funerary text would fail to reproduce Abraham. It also recognizes that revelation models face historical questions of their own. [16]

The defense can then appeal to Smith's broader use of the word translation, possible ancient parallels, and the book's religious content. The Church's essay includes both missing-material and revelatory possibilities. A reader who already has independent confidence in Smith's prophetic authority may regard those possibilities as sufficient to retain the book. [2]

This argument has real force against the assertion that the surviving fragments exhaust everything Smith possessed. It has less force as positive proof of an Abraham manuscript. Descriptions of a roll establish that observers saw material; identifying its exact contents still requires access or reliable linguistic evidence.

Claims about ancient parallels also need individual testing. A place-name resemblance or shared Abraham tradition can be interesting. Its evidential weight depends on specificity, dating, transmission, availability to Smith, and competing explanations. This case does not treat a list of proposed parallels as either a completed authentication or a completed refutation.

The fairest version of the LDS argument is therefore conditional: **the surviving mismatch may not test the entire ancient source that believers understand Smith to have translated.** The unresolved task is to establish that proposed source, and to account for the working papers and published facsimile explanations.

Competing explanations

Model one A translation of surviving Egyptian material

This model offers the most direct test: compare recoverable signs with their proposed English meaning. The funerary readings and facsimile difficulties weigh strongly against an ordinary linguistic translation into the Book of Abraham. Invoking divine assistance does not remove the need to show the claimed correspondence. [14–15]

Model two An Abrahamic text on missing papyri

This model accommodates the incomplete collection and takes the original connection with papyri seriously. Its central weakness is the unavailable source. The possibility of missing text is established; the presence of an Abrahamic composition within it is not. Nor does a lost narrative automatically resolve the separately published interpretations of surviving or reproduced images. [16–19]

Model three Revelation prompted by the artifacts

On this account, the papyri served as a catalyst rather than as the linguistic source of the English narrative. It can explain why ordinary Egyptian readings do not reproduce Abraham. It also reduces the extent to which the English can be tested as a translation of those objects.

The corresponding burden changes: why should this revelation be accepted as Abraham's record or as scripture? The proposal must address the original translation language and specific facsimile explanations. Saying that revelation is possible answers a different question from showing that this revelation occurred.

Model four A nineteenth-century composition

A naturalistic explanation places the English work in Smith's religious environment, with biblical language, contemporary interests, and creative interpretation of artifacts. This avoids requiring an undiscovered Abrahamic text. It fits the fact that the documented English production is nineteenth-century, but that date alone does not explain every idea's origin.

This model also has different versions. A sincere belief in revelation, a mistaken decipherment, deliberate invention, or some combination would imply different intentions. The documentary mismatch cannot select among those psychological accounts by itself. Historical criticism is strongest when it specifies a failed claim rather than claiming access to an author's mind.

Comparative judgment: The available evidence is more consistent with an English religious composition produced in the nineteenth century than with a verified linguistic translation of recoverable Egyptian. Whether that composition was divinely revealed remains a further religious claim; the papyri do not independently establish it.

Motives benefits and costs

The acquisition cost money, required collaborators, and offered opportunities for publication and public religious influence. Coe's letter recalls financial commitments and an expectation that publication might repay them. That evidence supports discussing economic hopes alongside economic costs. It does not demonstrate that anticipated revenue caused a false claim. [12–13]

Authority also matters. A newly recovered record attributed to Abraham could strengthen a prophet's standing and give distinctive teachings an ancient setting. That is a plausible institutional benefit. It is an inference about the effect of the claim, not proof that personal ambition generated it.

Sincere religious commitment could also motivate study, expenditure, and publication. Sincerity would explain persistence without establishing accuracy. Conversely, a person might endure costs while still seeking influence or defending an error. Benefit and sacrifice can coexist.

No evidence examined here justifies a sexual-motive finding for the production of the Book of Abraham. Importing allegations from other case files would substitute association for proof. This investigation assesses the incentives relevant to this record and leaves unsupported accusations out.

A biblical assessment

This section states an evangelical and Trinitarian Christian reading. Its question is whether the book's distinctive teachings agree with the biblical witness. It does not use doctrinal disagreement as a shortcut to an Egyptological conclusion.

Premortal intelligences and Christ

Abraham 3:18 and 22-28 describes intelligences, a premortal setting, and a council connected with the earth's purpose. Christians affirm Christ's preexistence from passages such as John 1:1-3. That affirmation does not by itself establish that all human beings inhabited the same kind of premortal society. [21–22]

Jeremiah 1:5 speaks of God's knowledge and appointment of Jeremiah before birth. Reading it in context, the passage does not explicitly describe Jeremiah living as a conscious spirit before conception. Foreknowledge and premortal personal existence should not be treated as interchangeable without argument.

The Gods and creation

Abraham 4 describes the Gods organizing the heavens and earth. Genesis 1 opens with God as creator; Isaiah 43:10 and 44:6 emphasize God's uniqueness; John 1:1-3 and Colossians 1:16 place creation through the divine Word or Son. The Christian assessment asks how the Book of Abraham's plurality relates to that Creator-creature distinction. [21–22]

This is not settled by pointing out that the Hebrew word *Elohim* has a plural form or that Genesis 1:26 uses “us.” Those observations require grammatical and contextual interpretation; they do not alone establish the LDS account of multiple Gods. Nor should the verb translated create be

said, by itself, always to mean creation from nothing. The argument must rest on the wider biblical account.

Abraham's promise and priesthood

Abraham 2:9-11 connects the worldwide blessing with priesthood and Abraham's seed. Genesis 12:1-3 promises blessing through Abraham. Galatians 3:6-9, 14, and 16 interprets that blessing through faith and its fulfillment in Christ. Romans 4:1-5 likewise uses Abraham to explain righteousness credited through faith. [21–22]

The comparison should ask what authorizes the additional priesthood framework and how it relates to Christ's priesthood in Hebrews 7:23-28. Additional detail is not automatically a contradiction. It becomes a theological problem where it changes who God is, how salvation is received, or the authority through which people approach him.

Testing a claimed revelation

Galatians 1:6-9 and 1 John 4:1-3 require discernment rather than automatic acceptance of a religious claim. A Christian can ask whether a proposed revelation agrees with the apostolic gospel while also asking whether its historical claims survive examination. A powerful spiritual impression should not erase an identifiable documentary problem. [22]

The same discipline applies to Christian claims. Many biblical texts survive in later copies, so an autograph demand applied only to Abraham would be inconsistent. Christianity should present its own evidence for textual transmission, historical events, and theological interpretation. It is not authenticated merely by finding a weakness in LDS claims.

Findings and confidence

The confidence terms describe the evidence available in this investigation. They are qualitative judgments, not calculated probabilities.

Finding	Confidence	Reason and limit
An Egyptian project and English publication are documented.	High	Surviving manuscripts, journals, and 1842 printing. [5–11]
Surviving Egyptian texts are funerary, rather than Abraham's English narrative.	High	Specialist readings identify funerary content. This finding concerns surviving material. [4, 14–15]
The collection is incomplete.	High	Lost portions are documented; their exact contents remain unknown. [3, 16]
Published facsimile identities face substantial difficulties.	High, broadly	Central identities differ; damaged signs and symbolic defenses qualify details. [15, 17–20]
A missing Abraham manuscript has been demonstrated.	Not established	No verified source. Missing papyri permit the proposal without confirming it.
Smith knowingly deceived his collaborators.	Not established by this case	Textual problems do not establish private intent.
The book is divinely revealed scripture.	A theological judgment	Historical evidence informs the claim; artifacts do not independently authenticate revelation.

Overall assessment

The Book of Abraham is a more directly testable translation case than a claim whose proposed original is entirely unavailable. Recoverable Egyptian material and published explanations permit specific comparisons. Those comparisons create a substantial historical obstacle to accepting the work as an accurate linguistic translation of the material we can examine.

Missing-text and catalyst explanations remain distinct possibilities within LDS belief. The first lacks a verified ancient source; the second makes divine revelation carry more of the explanatory burden. Neither should be presented as a discovery that resolves every documentary difficulty.

From the Christian perspective used here, the book's teachings also require testing against Scripture. That theological assessment strengthens the need for care; it does not authorize exaggerating the historical evidence. A fair conclusion can be firm about a mismatch, cautious about missing material, and restrained about motives at the same time.

The question to carry forward: When a claimed revelation is attached to an ancient artifact, what evidence should connect the artifact, the English text, and the authority being requested?

Read compare and discuss

1. Read the 1842 heading and the current LDS essay. What does each say about the relationship between papyri, translation, and revelation?
2. Compare the surviving Horos fragment with the published Facsimile 1. Which details survive, and which depend on reconstruction?
3. Read the explanations of Facsimile 3 alongside the Egyptological discussion. Which claims concern a literal name, and which concern a possible symbolic association?
4. Which evidence establishes that an activity occurred? Which evidence would establish that the activity produced an accurate translation?

5. How much explanatory weight should missing material carry? What new discovery would materially strengthen or weaken the missing-papyrus model?
6. If the papyri were only a catalyst, what independent reason would you need to accept the resulting text as Abraham's words?
7. Compare Abraham 3-4 with Genesis 1, Isaiah 44:6, John 1:1-3, and Colossians 1:16. Where do the accounts agree, and where do their theological frameworks differ?
8. What evidence would cause you to revise your own conclusion? Apply that question to both LDS and Christian claims.

For a conversation with an LDS friend, begin by asking which explanation they actually hold. Summarize it in terms they recognize before responding. Then examine one concrete claim together. An argument about a missing scroll will go nowhere if the other person is defending a revelation independent of the scroll.

For a family or small group, divide the work into three readings: historical evidence; competing explanations; biblical comparison. Let participants distinguish an observation, an inference, and a faith commitment. The aim is a reasoned judgment and an honest conversation, with respect for the people affected by the conclusion.

Accuracy notes and further research

- **Collection limits:** The surviving fragments do not represent everything Smith possessed. No reconstruction of the lost collection should be treated as certain without showing its evidence.
- **Originals and engravings:** Facsimile 1 has surviving ancient material; the original sources of Facsimiles 2 and 3 are not extant. Damage and nineteenth-century copying affect detailed comparisons.
- **Production sequence:** The manuscripts document relationships among characters, explanations, and English text. They do not preserve an uncontested account of the order in which every element was produced.
- **Witness provenance:** Chandler's certificate survives in a later 1835 copy and publication. Coe's letter is an 1844 recollection. Scribe-kept journals are distinct from later compiled historical narratives.
- **Expert disagreement:** The specialist sources are not interchangeable. Baer and Ritner provide Egyptian readings; Gee argues for a missing source; the BYU Studies discussion offers a defense concerning Isis and kingship. A reader should inspect the relevant argument rather than count institutional affiliations.
- **Parallels:** This case does not independently resolve every proposed ancient parallel. Claims about particular names, geography, astronomy, or ancient Abraham traditions need separate, documented investigation.
- **Intent and theology:** A failed translation claim does not, by itself, prove conscious fraud. An unresolved historical question does not, by itself, establish divine revelation.

Sources and reading

The supplied research packet provided the study framework. The records and analyses below support the historical comparisons. Archival editorial introductions are distinguished from the documents they describe; specialist interpretations are attributed to their authors. Online sources checked November 8, 2026.

[1] Supplied research packet. *LDS Gospel Topics Essays*, Book of Abraham section, physical PDF pages 324-365. Unpublished working research provided for Religion Comparison; page 324 is the section cover. Used as a synthesis and question framework, not as independent historical corroboration.

[2] The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints. Translation and Historicity of the Book of Abraham. Official statement presenting the Church's position and possible relationships between the book and the papyri.

[3] Joseph Smith Papers. Introduction to Revelations and Translations, Volume 4. Editorial overview of acquisition, manuscripts, publication, and surviving materials. This is modern archival synthesis, not a nineteenth-century eyewitness statement.

[4] Joseph Smith Papers. Fragment of Book of Breathing for Horos-A, between 238 and circa 153 BC. Artifact image, source note, and editorial discussion of the vignette published as Facsimile 1.

[5] Joseph Smith Papers. Book of Abraham Manuscript A, circa July-November 1835, Abraham 1:4-2:6. Manuscript images, transcription, and editorial introduction; use page controls to inspect the document.

[6] Joseph Smith Papers. Book of Abraham Manuscript C, circa July-November 1835, Abraham 1:1-2:18. Translation heading, English text, marginal characters, and scribal evidence.

[7] Joseph Smith Papers. Egyptian Alphabet A, circa early July-November 1835. Includes Smith's handwriting; evidence should not be generalized to every Egyptian document.

[8] Joseph Smith Papers. Grammar and Alphabet of the Egyptian Language, circa July-November 1835. Images, transcription, and scribal context for the grammar project.

[9] Joseph Smith Papers. Journal, 1835-1836, page 3. October 1, 1835 entry concerning work on an Egyptian alphabet. Consult the source note for scribal and dating information.

[10] Joseph Smith Papers. Journal, December 1841-December 1842, page 89. March 8-9, 1842 entries on translation and revision; recorded in Willard Richards's handwriting.

[11] Joseph Smith Papers. Book of Abraham and Facsimiles, March 1-May 16, 1842. Original *Times and Seasons* publication. Printed page 704 contains the translation heading.

[12] Michael Chandler. Certificate, July 6, 1835, preserved in a late-December 1835 copy. Also see the 1835 published version. The certificate is a dealer's endorsement, not a surviving independent Egyptological audit.

[13] Joseph Coe. Letter to Joseph Smith, January 1, 1844. Retrospective account of financial contributions and anticipated repayment through publication.

[14] Klaus Baer. The Breathing Permit of Hor: A Translation of the Apparent Source of the Book of Abraham. *Dialogue* 3, no. 3 (Autumn 1968), 109-134. Specialist translation following examination of the papyri.

[15] Robert K. Ritner. The Breathing Permit of Hor Thirty-Four Years Later. *Journal of Near Eastern Studies* 62, no. 3 (July 2003), 161-180. Publisher record and DOI; accessible copy of the paper. Egyptian translation and facsimile discussion; distinguish philological findings from the author's polemical judgments.

[16] John Gee. The Relationship of the Book of Abraham Text to the Papyri, chapter 7, pages 83-86, in *An Introduction to the Book of Abraham* (2017). LDS Egyptologist's argument comparing surviving-text, missing-text, and revelation models.

[17] Pearl of Great Price. Abraham, Facsimile 1 and explanation. Current canonical presentation; compare with the surviving fragment and the 1842 engraving.

[18] Pearl of Great Price. Abraham, Facsimile 2 and explanation. Current canonical presentation of the hypocephalus and assigned meanings.

[19] Pearl of Great Price. Abraham, Facsimile 3 and explanation. Specific published identifications, including claims that names appear in the characters.

[20] Stephen O. Smoot, John Gee, Kerry Muhlestein, and John S. Thompson. Isis the Pharaoh, Facsimile 3, Figure 2. *BYU Studies* 61, no. 4 (2022), page 276 onward. LDS response discussing engraving quality, the reading Isis, and royal associations. Rhodes's reading is consulted through this discussion, not through an independent examination of his full book.

[21] Pearl of Great Price. Abraham chapter 2, chapter 3, and chapter 4. Primary doctrinal texts for covenant, intelligences, and creation comparisons.

[22] The Bible, King James Version. Principal comparison passages: Genesis 1; Genesis 12:1-3; Isaiah 43:10 and 44:6; Jeremiah 1:5; John 1:1-3; Romans 4:1-5; Galatians 3; Colossians 1:16; Hebrews 7:23-28; Galatians 1:6-9; 1 John 4:1-3. Read the passages in context. Website headings and footnotes are editorial aids, not part of the KJV text.

Collection notes

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